



Financial Literacy Made Simple

## My **ROLE**

I led design on this project as the sole designer, collaborating with a team of 5 engineers.

- Product Designer
- UX Researcher

## My **IMPACT**

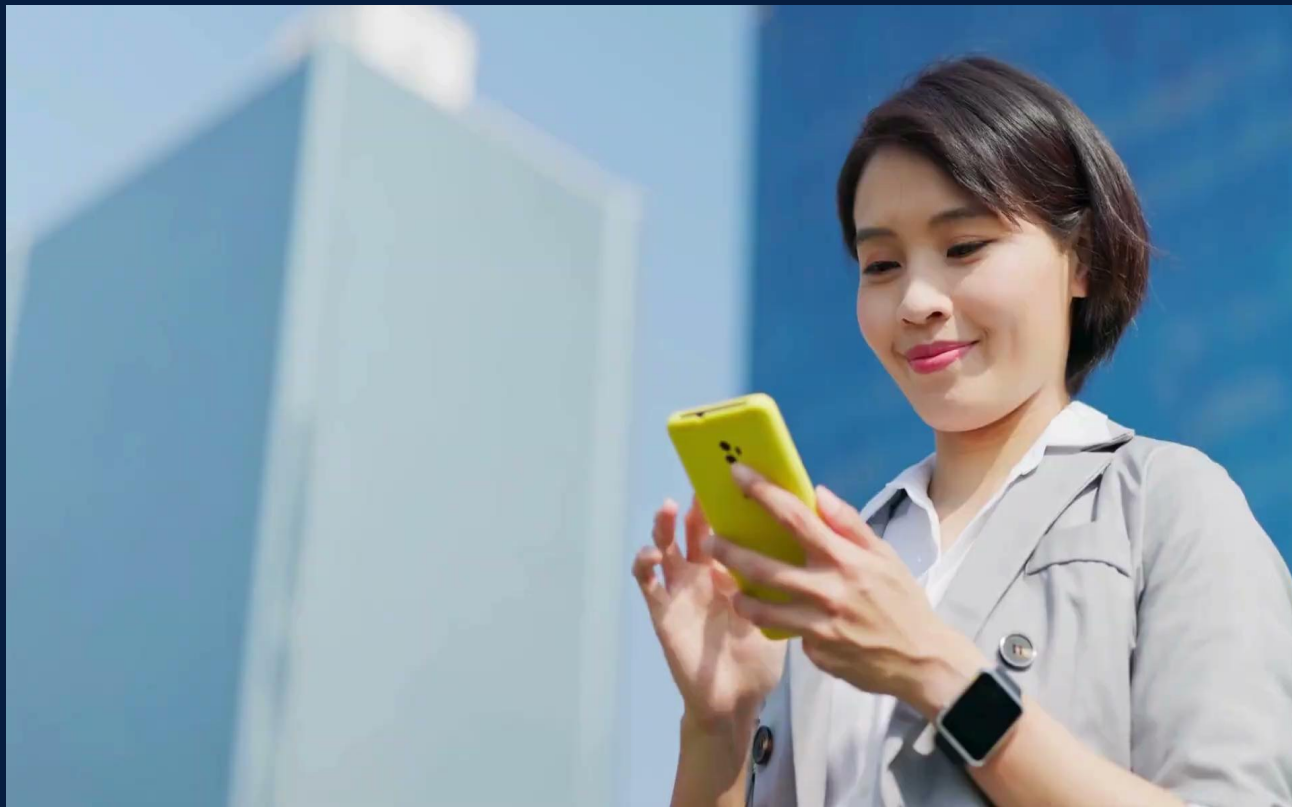
- Improved financial literacy engagement for first-time learners by designing a personalized, mobile-first experience across web and app platforms.
- Simplified complex onboarding, learning styles, and progress tracking—resulting in a more intuitive, inclusive user journey tailored to individual financial goals.

## My **TEAM**

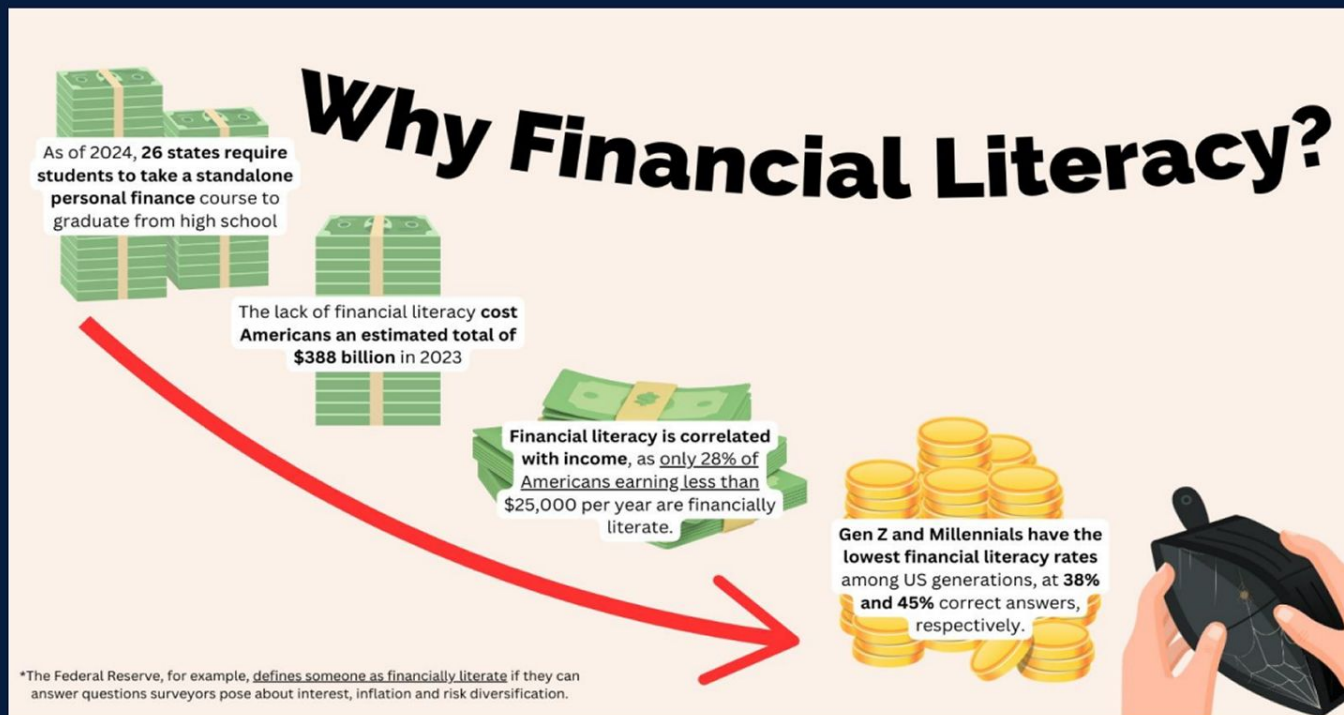
- 1 Content Strategist
- 1 Product Manager
- 2 Front End Developers
- 2 Back End Developers
- 1 AI/ML Engineer

## **DURATION**

10 months: June–April 2024



# The Problem



## Understanding the **PROBLEM**

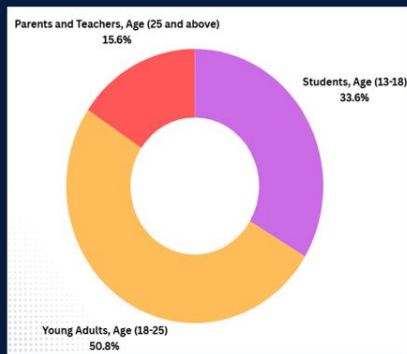
- **Low Financial Optimism:** Only 16% of Americans aged 18–26 feel optimistic about their financial future.
- **Key Struggles:** Many young adults face challenges with debt management, budgeting, and investing.
- **Complexity of Existing Resources:** Traditional financial education materials are often too complex and formal, leading to disengagement.
- **Engagement Gap:** Lack of accessible and engaging resources results in low financial literacy among young adults.

## FinEd's **SOLUTION**

A user-centered, gamified approach and providing real world context to financial education tailored to different literacy levels.

## Market Opportunity (US)

Target Market



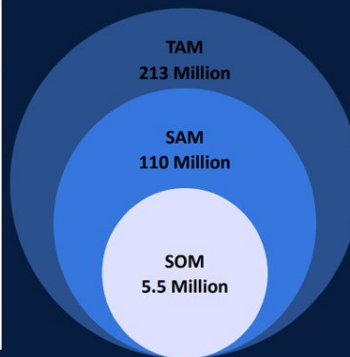
Over 70% of students, young adults, parents, and educators actively engage with financial literacy applications, highlighting a growing demand for tools that simplify managing and understanding personal finances."

Market Growth  
(Industry)



The Education App Market is expected to grow at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 9.98% during the 2024 to 2030 period.

Market Size



Total Available Market (TAM): 213mm  
Serviceable Available Market (SAM): 110mm  
Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM): 5.5mm

## Turning **PROBLEMS INTO GOALS**

I felt I had a good understanding of the biggest problems that needed tackling with this financial literacy provider product, making these three items my main goals for the project:

- **User Retention:** Keeping users engaged through gamified, AI generated personalized content to avoid dropout.
- **Monetization:** Striking a balance between freemium vs premium content with an adaptable freemium model.
- **Awareness & Engagement:** Providing real world context to financial news pieces tailored to different literacy levels for better understanding.

# Projected Financials

**30% Yearly User  
Growth Rate**

**25% Conversion Rate  
(Premium Subscribers)**

**56%  
Avg PBT % (over 5 years)**

**\$10M+ in Annual Revenue  
After Year 5**

**Rev, Exp, NI (100k Users)**



\*Based on 100k users at Year 1



## Discover and **RESEARCH**

To set a strong foundation for FinEd, I built on insights from a **survey, interviews and previously conducted research by the company's founder**, which highlighted **key demographic trends and user learning preferences**.

# Customer Demographics

### • Demographic

#### Age

Primarily 13-40 years old, the core Millennial and Gen Z segment

#### Gender

Relative equal distribution

#### Education

Emerging Graduates  
Early Earners

### • Behavioral

#### Financial Habits

Low to moderate savings  
High levels of student loan debt  
Interest in investing but lack of knowledge

#### Tech Savviness

High smartphone usage  
Comfortable with digital learning platforms

#### Engagement

Seek information from online sources  
Active on social media platforms

### • Psychographic / Technography

#### Lifestyle

Busy and fast-paced lifestyle  
Concerned about financial security/planning

#### Attitudes

Desire for personalized financial advice  
Skeptical of traditional financial institutions  
Open to new ideas and technology

#### Device Usage

Willing to download and use new apps

### Key Target Segments of Our Average Customer

#### The Novice Student

Young adults with high student loan debt, learning to budget, save, and build credit

#### The Aspiring Investor

Millennials interested in investing but lack knowledge and confidence

#### The Busy Professional

Mid-career professionals looking for time-efficient ways to improve their financial literacy

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# Acquisition Strategy and Channels

## Influencer Marketing Strategy

Leveraging influencers in the education and finance sectors to amplify brand awareness and user acquisition, to reach niche audiences and foster a sense of community.

## Institutional Collaborations

Partnerships with educational institutions to not only increase visibility but also credibility, as the app becomes an endorsed resource within academic environments, driving user trust and adoption.

## Targeted Social Campaigns

Data-driven social media campaigns that focus on target demographics to enhance user engagement and conversion rates.

# User Retention and Community Building



ENGAGEMENT  
THROUGH  
GAMIFICATION



COMMUNITY  
RECOGNITION



PERSONALIZED  
COMMUNICATION  
STRATEGIES

## Secondary **RESEARCH**

Analyzed market trends in workshops **with stakeholders and project manager** to facilitate:

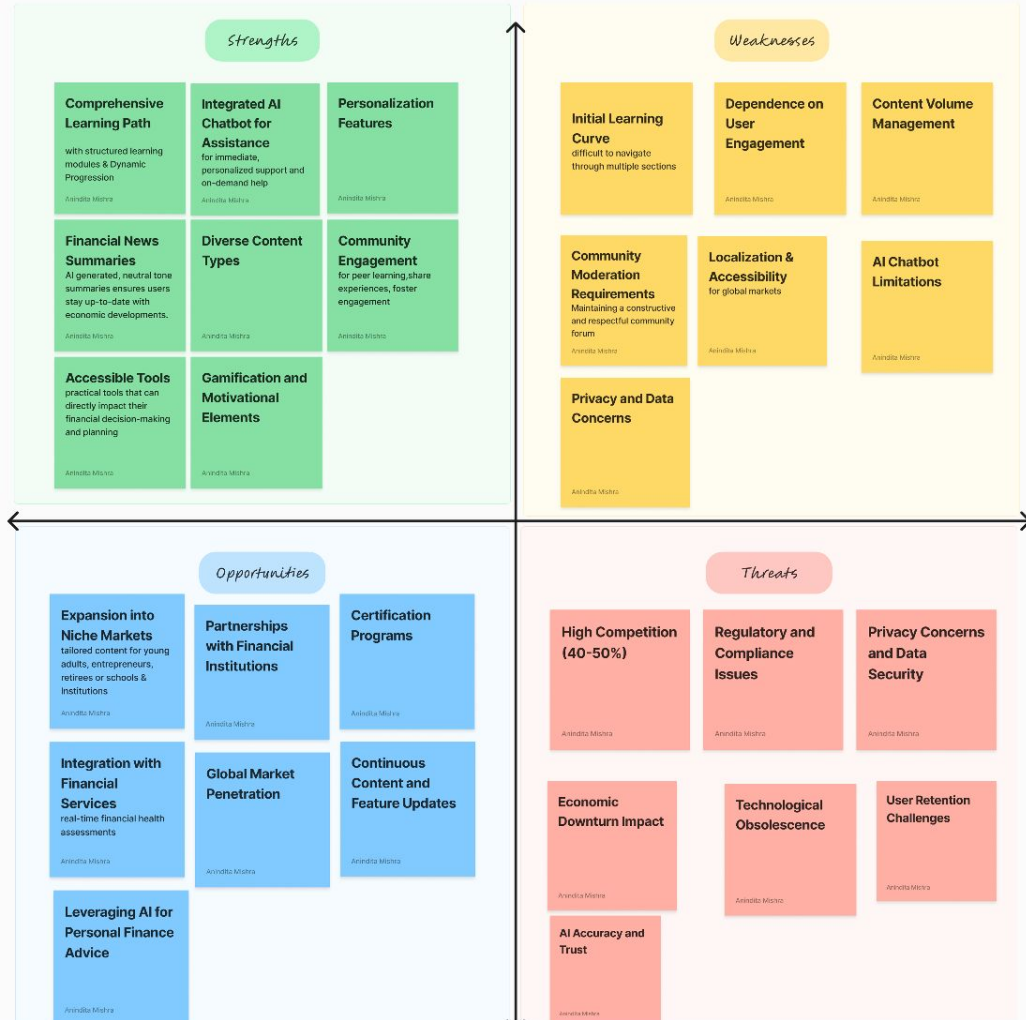
- SWOT Analysis
- Competitive Analysis

These **collaborative efforts** helped me understand:

- User needs
- Competitive landscape
- Potential challenges

Ensuring our product's direction was well-informed and strategically aligned with user expectations.

## SWOT Analysis





## Secondary RESEARCH

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## Competitive Analysis

|              | <p><b>Unique Value Proposition</b><br/>What makes this company unique?</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <p><b>Company Advantages</b><br/>What are the things that provide a leg up?</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <p><b>Company disadvantages</b><br/>Where might drawbacks exist?</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| BLOOM        | <p>Bloom gives teenagers the opportunity to open actual custodial investing accounts, allowing them to practice managing their own portfolios under parental guidance. Bloom's direct approach to investing distinguishes it from applications that are exclusively devoted to financial literacy.</p> <p>Investors can begin with as little as \$1 and monitor the performance of their portfolios to gain insight into how assets increase in value over time.</p> | <p>Bloom offers a distinctive feature that enables parents to establish guidelines and track their child's development. This makes it particularly appealing to parents who want to instill in their teenagers sound financial practices in a controlled setting.</p> <p>The app offers bite-sized lessons on complex investment topics such as stocks, ETFs, and bonds, making investment concepts approachable for young users. Its gamified quizzes and progress tracking encourage continuous learning.</p>                                                | <p>Bloom concentrates on investment, but its usefulness for teenagers looking for a comprehensive financial education is limited because it does not provide comprehensive elements for broader financial education, such as budgeting, credit management, or debt handling.</p> <p>Bloom's model heavily relies on parental oversight, which can limit its appeal to teens who seek more independence in managing their finances. This also may discourage parents who prefer their teens to learn through trial and error.</p>     |
| ZOGO         | <p>With Zogo, learning about finance is enjoyable and engaging since users receive prizes (such as gift cards) for finishing short instructional courses.</p> <p>Learning becomes more appealing because of this gamification strategy, which increases engagement and retention.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                | <p>Zogo is supported by partnerships with banks and credit unions, which adds credibility to its content. This connection to established financial organizations ensures that the app's lessons are aligned with real-world financial practices.</p> <p>Zogo offers over 300 modules on various personal finance topics, each broken down into short, digestible lessons. This approach caters to the fast-paced, mobile-friendly learning preferences of younger users.</p>                                                                                   | <p>Zogo's gamified learning technique could oversimplify difficult financial topics. Because of the micro-learning structure, users could not get a thorough enough understanding of complicated financial issues.</p> <p>Zogo focuses primarily on theoretical learning without the real-world tools to manage money directly, like budgeting or investment simulators, which could be less practical for users looking for hands-on experience.</p>                                                                                |
| MINT         | <p>With its unique combination of bill tracking, credit score monitoring, investment tracking, and budgeting all combined into one app,</p> <p>Mint stands out for its comprehensive approach to personal finance. For consumers looking for a one-stop shop for financial management, this is the best option.</p>                                                                                                                                                  | <p>Mint automatically links credit cards and bank accounts, displaying transactions to offer up-to-date information on spending patterns. Users find it simpler to manage their finances and stick to a budget thanks to this automated tool.</p> <p>Credit score checks are only one of the many useful financial functions that Mint offers for free, in contrast to many other apps. This presents it as a more attractive substitute for consumers looking for all-inclusive financial monitoring without having to pay a monthly subscription charge.</p> | <p>The vast array of functions offered by Mint may prove difficult for those with no experience in the area of financial management. The platform has strong yet sophisticated tools that may be difficult for beginners to completely comprehend and use.</p> <p>Because Mint is free, it displays advertisements and makes suggestions for financial products, which some users find bothersome. Because the app manages sensitive financial data, there have also been questions raised regarding its data privacy practices.</p> |
| KHAN ACADEMY | <p>All ages and socioeconomic levels can attend Khan Academy because it provides a vast array of free courses on entrepreneurship, economics, and personal finance.</p> <p>Its dedication to opening up education distinguishes it from platforms that need payment or implement freemium business models.</p>                                                                                                                                                       | <p>The financial classes offered by Khan Academy are developed in conjunction with professionals in the field, guaranteeing accurate and trustworthy content.</p> <p>Its affiliation with respectable establishments like banks and financial advisors enhances its legitimacy and establishes it as a reliable source for financial literacy.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <p>The vast array of Although Khan Academy offers great video content, it is devoid of interactive elements that are necessary for learning real-world money management skills, such as financial simulations or budgeting tools.</p> <p>The more theoretical content in Khan Academy's financial classes might not give students the practical, hands-on experience they need to practice managing money in everyday situations, such as operating a savings account or balancing a budget.</p>                                     |

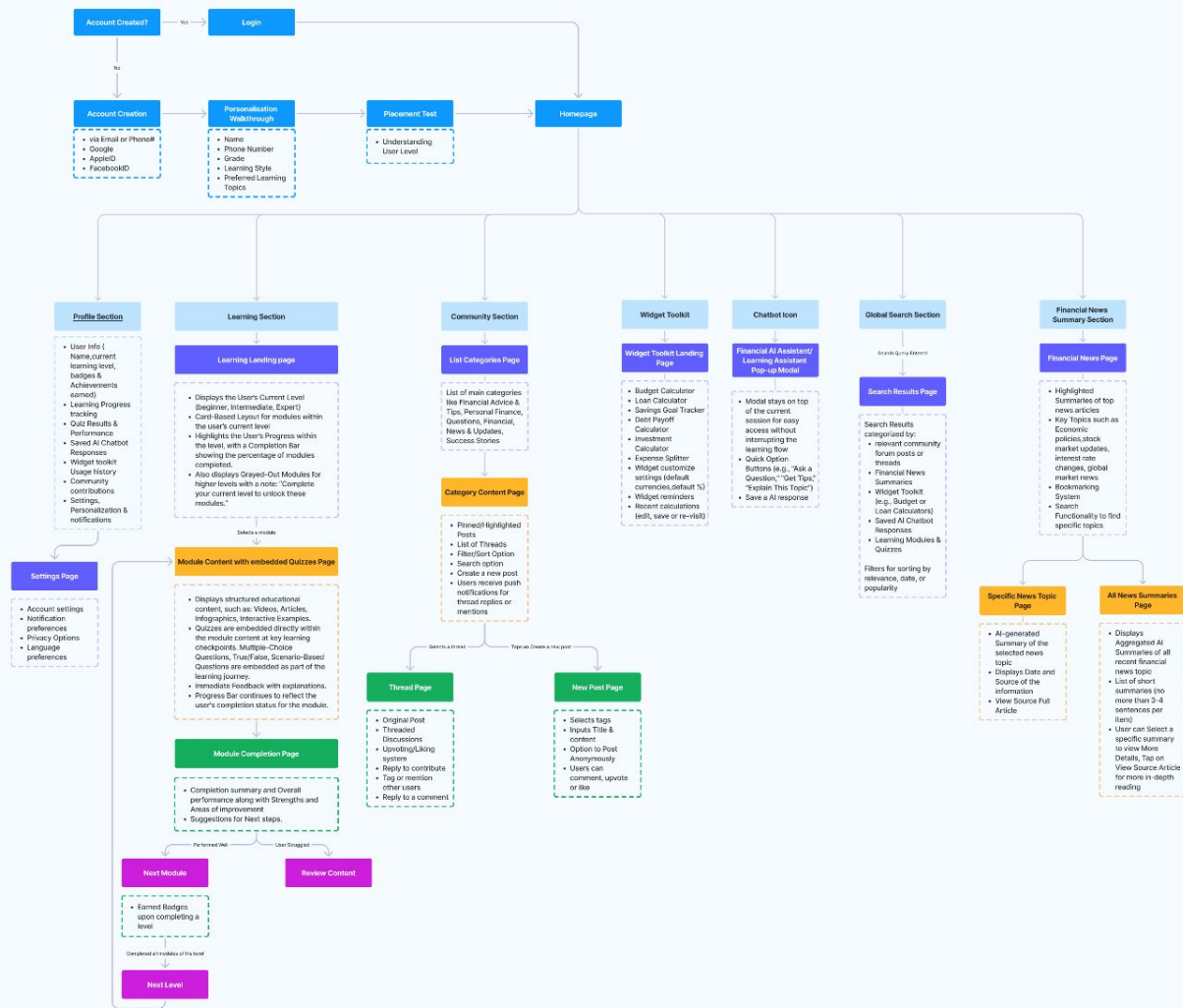
## Secondary **RESEARCH**

- **Gamification Enhances Engagement:** Apps like Bloom and Zogo effectively use challenges and incentives to maintain user interest.
- **Practical Tools Bridge Theory and Application:** Apps like Mint provide tools that enable real-world financial management.
- **Personalized Learning Drives Retention:** Platforms such as Khan Academy excel at tailoring educational experiences to user needs.
- **Partnerships Boost Credibility:** Collaborating with financial institutions, as seen with Zogo, enhances user trust and content depth

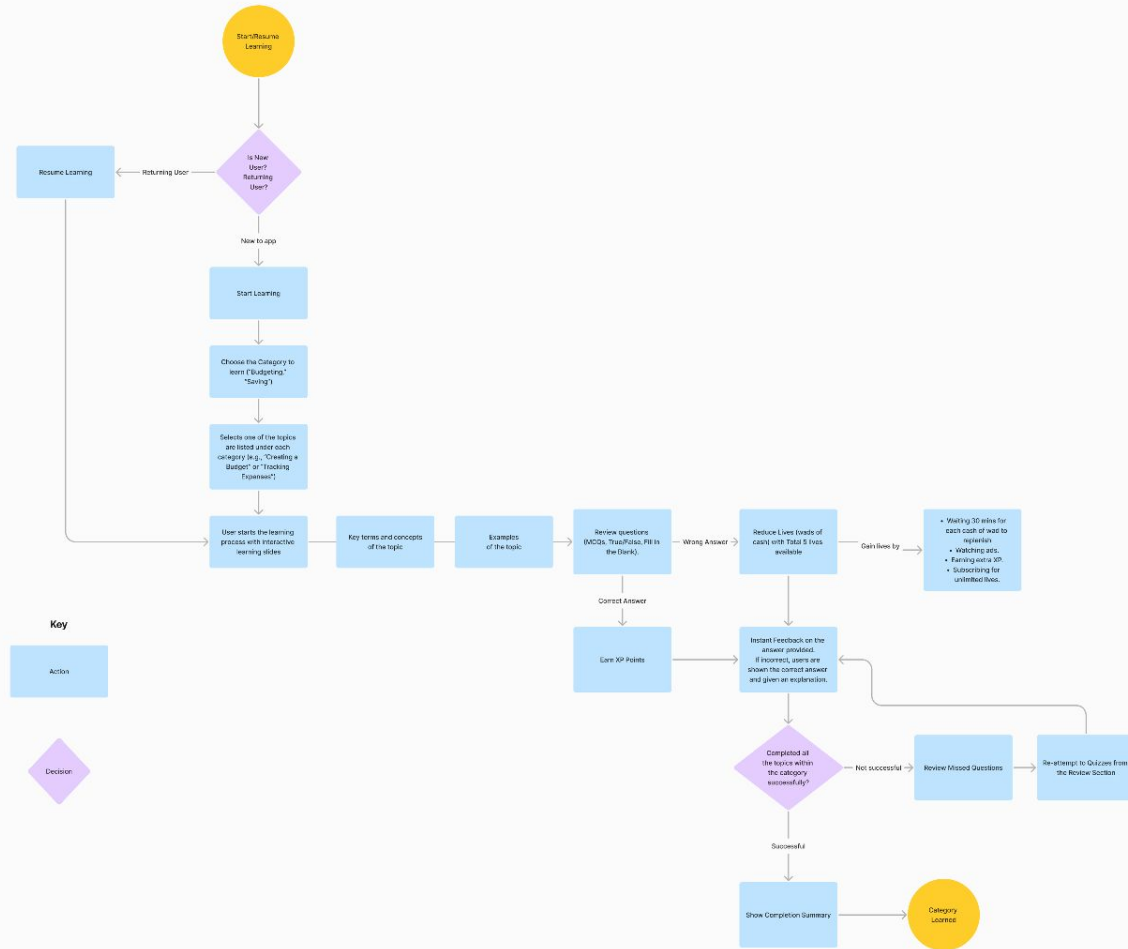
## Competitor Benchmarking

|             | Adaptive Learning Experience                                                      | Mobile First                                                                        | Gamification                                                                        | Community Features                                                                  | AI Tutor and Support                                                                |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FinEd       |  |  |  |  |  |
| NGPF        |  |  |  |  |  |
| Learnicity  |  |  |  |  |  |
| Doshi Learn |  |  |  |  |  |
| Mongo       |  |  |  |  |  |

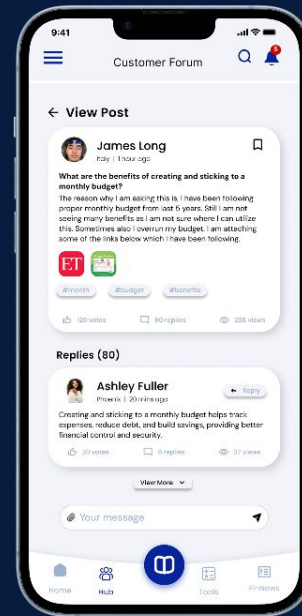
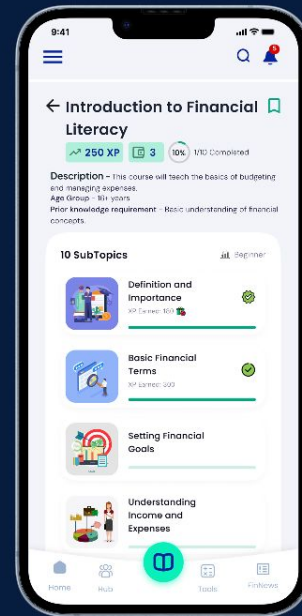
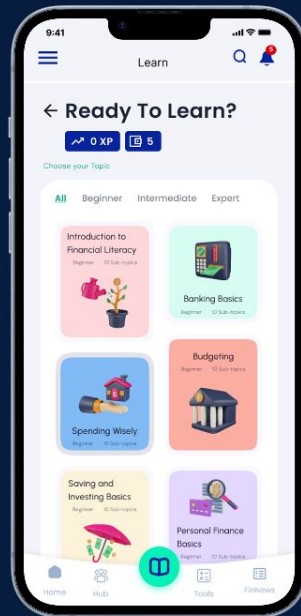
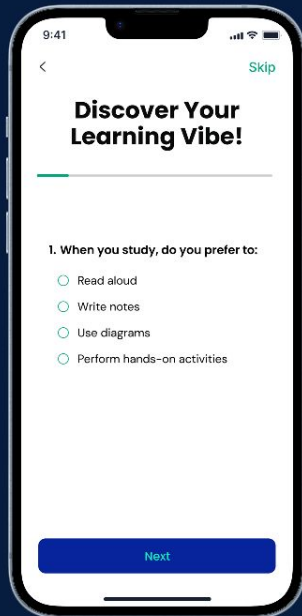
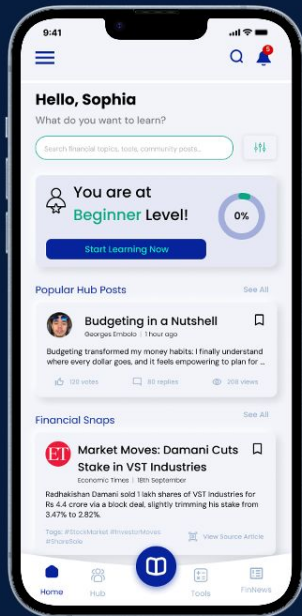
# SITEMAP



## FLOW CHART

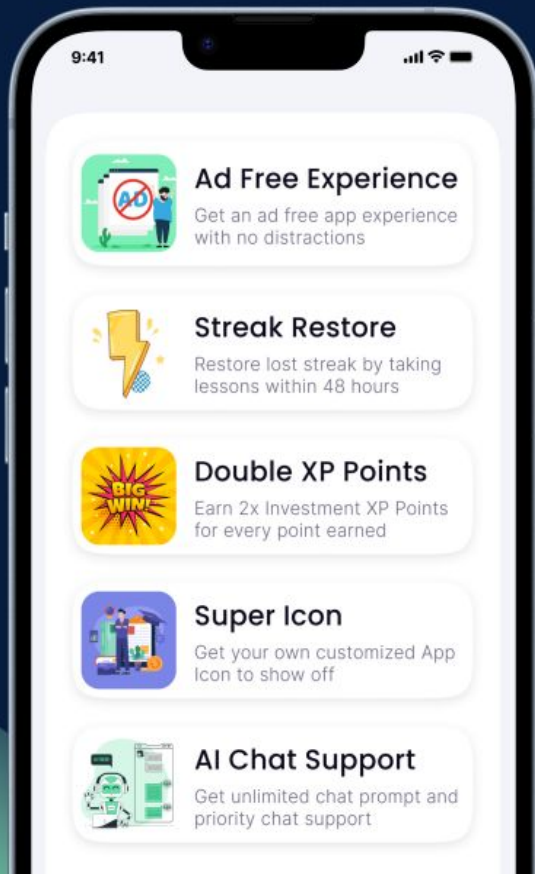


# PROTOTYPE and VISUAL DESIGN





# Freemium Business Model



The free model will have limited access to all main features to retain consumers before they find a need for premium features.

**Monthly Premium Plan – \$9.99/Month/User\***

## Other Revenue channels:

In-App  
Ads

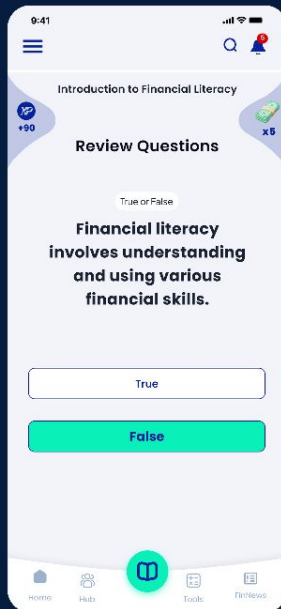
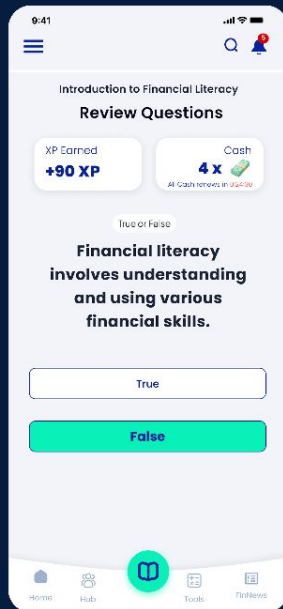
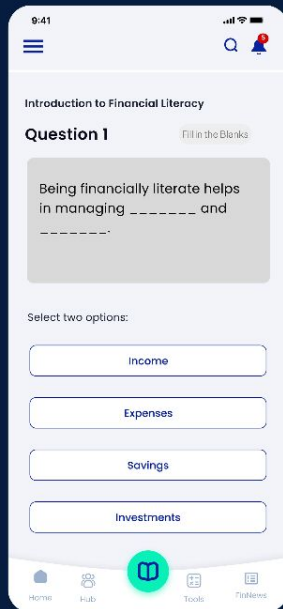
Partnerships

In-App  
Purchases

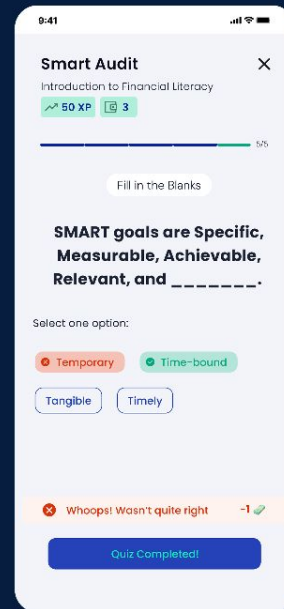
\*Average monthly paid subscription for educational apps

# USABILITY TESTING

Before



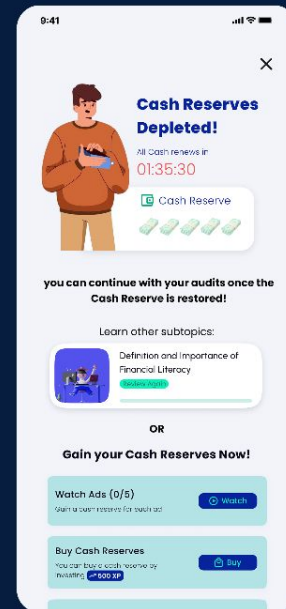
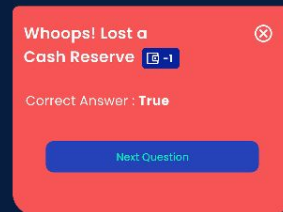
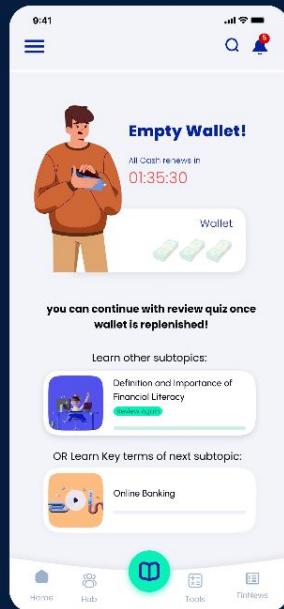
After



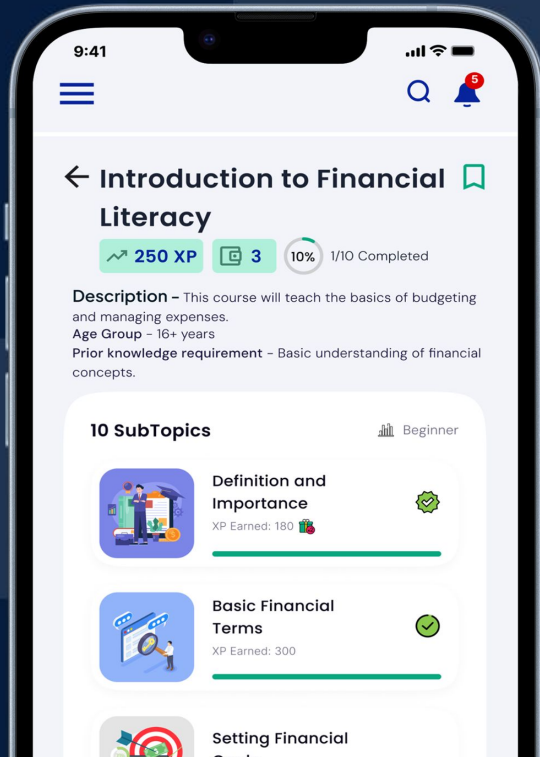
# USABILITY TESTING

Before

After



# Functionality and User Experiences



1

## Adaptive Learning Paths

Utilizing **machine learning algorithms** to create **personalized learning paths** based on user interactions and knowledge levels

2

## Data-Driven Insights

**Analytics** to provide users with **actionable insights** into their learning habits, enabling them to make informed decisions about their educational journey

3

## 'Arcade' Experience

**Game-like elements** such as **rewards, challenges, and leaderboards** to make learning engaging and fun.

## VISUAL EXAMPLE

**WHAT** Is Progress Blocker Task?

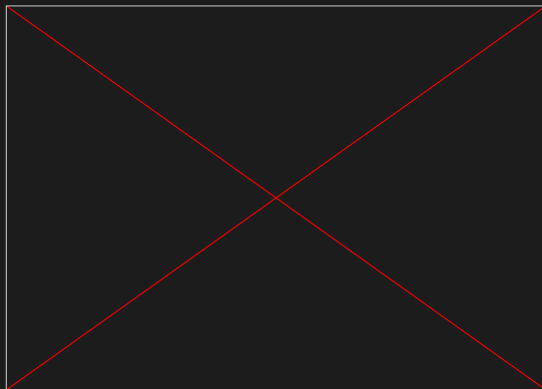
**WHY** Is It Affecting Progress?

- Boring according to primary users
- Traditional finance app "too static"
- No interactive elements and images
- Unclear micro-copy, error messages, navigation labels, conversational UX
- Real-world context for concepts

**SOLUTION** Business Model

- Gamification touch
- Financial news feature

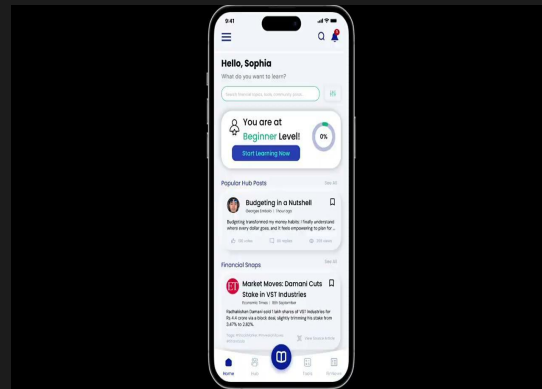
## GAMIFICATION Version



Attracted Young User & Boosts Engagement

- 60% increase in engagement with XP, badges, and progress tracking
- Users (15-40) found gamified learning more fun & motivating
- **User Feedback:** "Earning XP and unlocking levels makes learning finance feel more like a game, not like a chore!"
- Duolingo & Khan Academy use similar mechanics

## FINANCIAL NEWS Version



Improved Retention & Trust

- 2.5x more time spent by users who received personalized news
- 40% increase in daily logins with bite-sized financial news
- News made it more actionable and engaging
- Robinhood & Bloomberg use news for daily engagement



## COLLABORATION

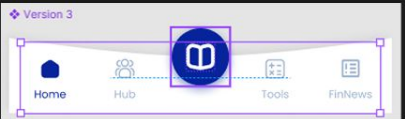
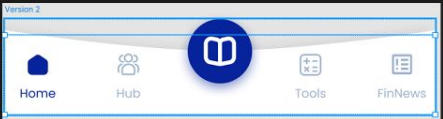
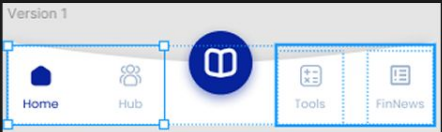
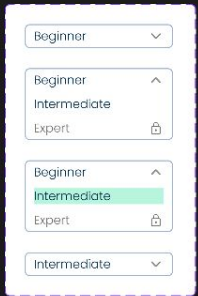
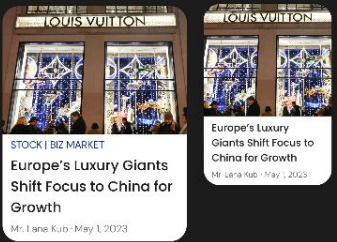
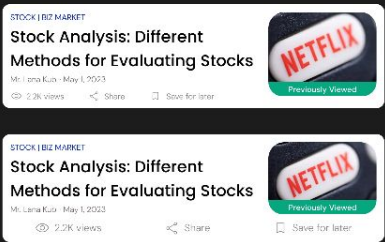
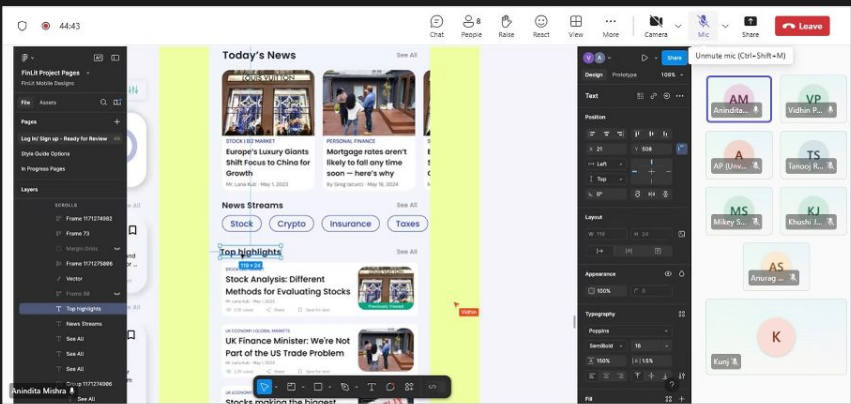
### How Cross Functional Collaboration Helps In Product Success And Progress?

- Talked with **product manager and owner** on content strategy of how words impact user experience
- Worked with **UX researcher** to understand the most effective ways to encourage app usage
- Partnered with **product designer lead** to integrate the feature into the user journey seamlessly
- Aligned with **behavioral scientist** to ensure the messaging feels encouraging rather than restrictive
- Connected with **developers** to seamless hand-off for AEM development
  - Checked for different UI components based on adaptive content

## IMPACT On Product

- Stakeholder buy-in was easier with user data & interactive demos
- Seamless dev hand-off, saving time and resources of the team

## MEETING Discussion and UI COMPONENT Versions



## COLLABORATION

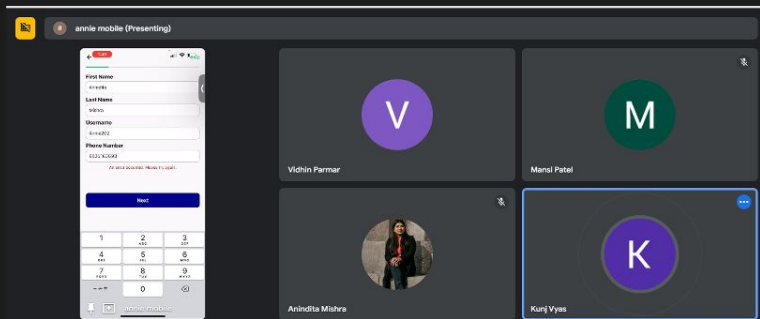
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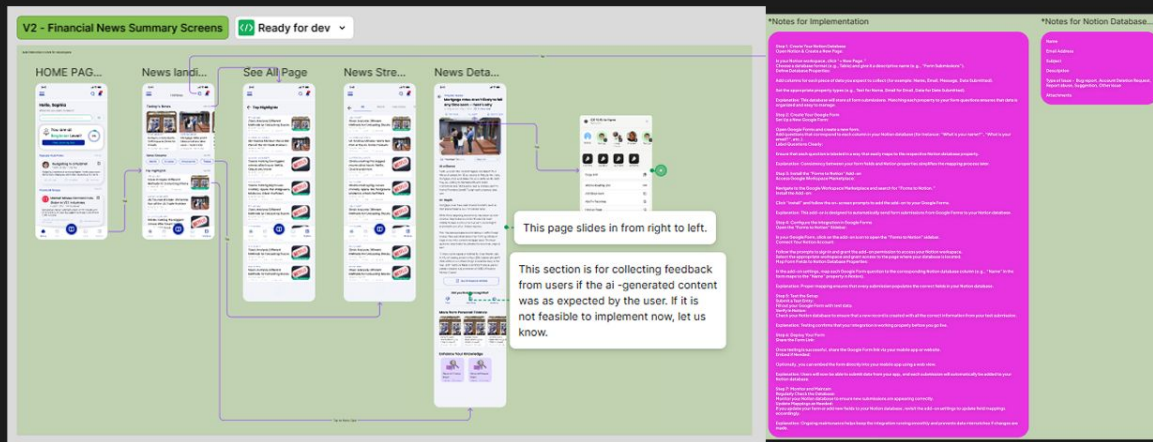
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Live **DEMO**



## DEV FILE – Interaction and Annotation Notes



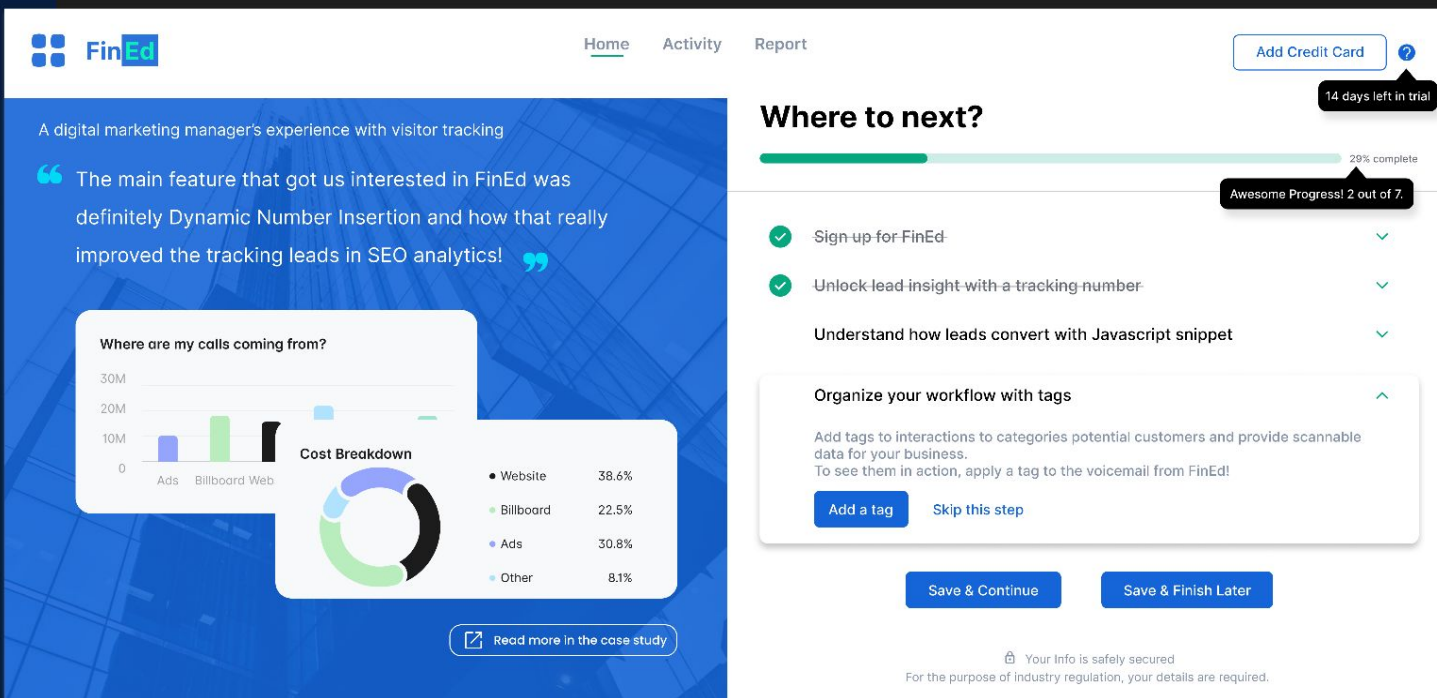
## FUTURE roadmap

### Next steps include:

- Continuing to test the live app for bugs and other needed tweaks
- After a short period, I will begin meeting with stakeholders again to see how they're liking (or not liking!) the functionality
- Continue to iterate and make it even better

### Ongoing:

- Web version of FinEd
- Onboarding for analytics tool



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Home Activity Report Add Credit Card ?

## Wow! You just completed a difficult task!

95% complete

Excellent! Only 2 steps left.

- ✓ Sign-up for FinEd
- ✓ Unlock lead insight with a tracking number
- ✓ Understand how leads convert with Javascript snippet
- ✓ Organize your workflow with tags

### Track your conversions with the Google Ads integration

Automatically track conversions from calls and form submissions to measure the effectiveness of your campaigns. The Google Ads integration will only work if you have our JS snippet installed and an active website pool.

[Activate Google Ads integration](#) [Skip this step](#)

[Save & Continue](#) [Save & Finish Later](#)

Your info is safely secured  
For the purpose of industry regulation, your details are required.

Home Activity Report Add Credit Card ?

## Congratulations!

### You have set your business up for success!



Please reach out to [Customer Support](#) if you have any questions.  
If you are looking for any additional resources, you can explore our [FinEd Community](#).

## You did it! 🎉

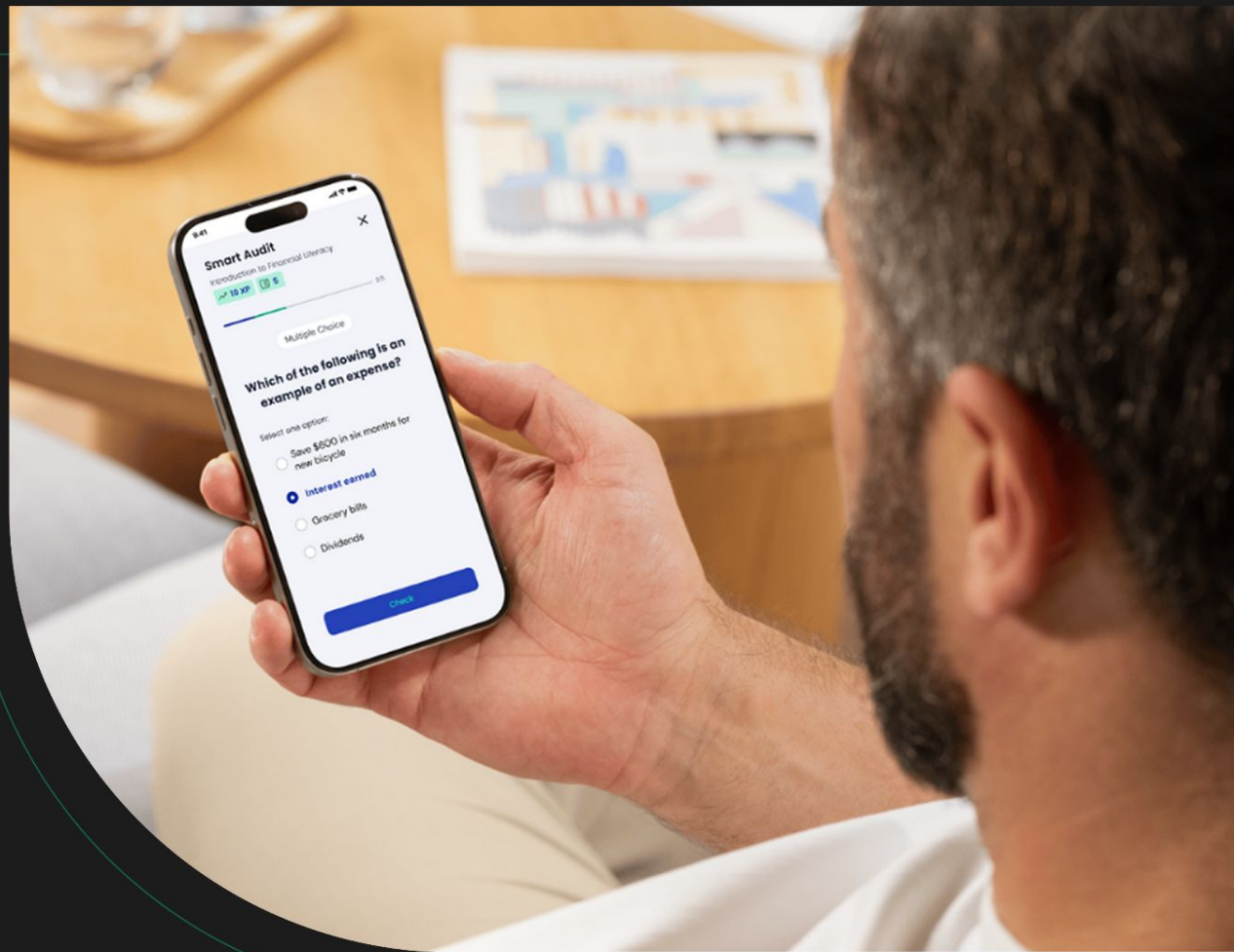
100% complete

- ✓ Sign-up for FinEd
- ✓ Unlock lead insight with a tracking number
- ✓ Understand how leads convert with Javascript snippet
- ✓ Organize your workflow with tags
- ✓ Track your conversions with the Google Ads integration
- ✓ Never miss a lead with notifications
- ✓ Deliver excellent customer experiences with call flows



## LEARNINGS

- This project **challenged me** in a lot of great ways. I got to pull in my knowledge and expertise from a lot of different areas (**UX design, UI design, interaction design, + more**) to create one, large final product that was a culmination of it all.
- I had the opportunity to collaborate daily with many of my colleagues, including **front-end developers, back-end developers, multiple stakeholders**, and more to ensure a successful build—which I really enjoyed!
- Having the chance to meet with some of **industry leaders, users, stakeholders** and learn about their wants and needs was awesome.
- Incorporating their feedback along the way will hopefully result in a successful mobile app as well as website that will serve them well for a long time to come.





**Thank You!**



Any questions? Please feel free to ask me.  
**Let's Discuss!**